

BONUS 3 OF 5 · FREE WITH YOUR COLLECTION

Lining, Zipper & Hardware Guide

How to line without puckering, add a zipper without warping the crochet and secure straps that don't stretch under weight — plus snaps, D-rings, slides, eyelets and rivets.

No sewing machine needed

Sizes in cm & inches

Troubleshooting table



The Crochet Backpack Collection

US terms · cm & inches · 2026 edition

What's inside

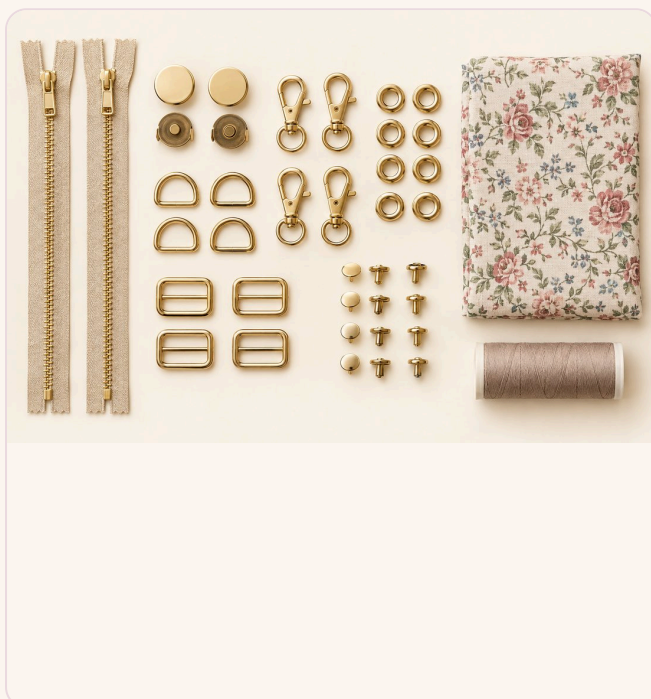
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SECTION 1

1. Your finishing kit

Everything on this page costs less than one sold backpack — and it is what makes the next one sell.

Crochet makes the body of the bag. Hardware and lining make it **last** and make it look store-bought. You don't need a sewing machine for anything in this guide.



TOOLS

- Sharp hand-sewing needles + 1 blunt tapestry needle
- Bonded nylon or upholstery thread (Tex 70 / size 69) — polyester all-purpose thread breaks under strap weight
- Fabric clips (20) — pins fall out of crochet
- Fabric scissors + small snips
- Awl or leather hole punch (2.5–4 mm)
- Rivet & eyelet setting kit (setter + anvil) + hammer + cutting board
- Iron, fusible interfacing, felt or plastic canvas scraps
- Fray check (or clear nail polish) + lighter for synthetic webbing

Hardware sizes that fit the collection

PART	SIZES TO STOCK	USE IT FOR	RULE
Zipper — nylon coil	#3 and #5 · 4, 5, 7, 8, 9, 12, 14, 16 in	Pouches, wallets, clutches, backpack tops	Coil can be shortened; buy by opening length
Zipper — metal	#5 · 7–16 in	Macramé and t-shirt yarn bags	Cannot be cut shorter easily: buy exact length
Two-way zipper	#5 · 14–18 in / 35–45 cm	Backpack main opening	Pulls meet in the center
Magnetic snap	14 mm and 18 mm	Flaps, clutches, tote tops	14 mm cotton · 18 mm t-shirt/cord
D-ring	15, 20, 25, 32 mm (5/8, 3/4, 1, 1 1/4 in)	Strap anchors, keyrings	Inner width = strap width

PART	SIZES TO STOCK	USE IT FOR	RULE
Slide adjuster (tri-glide)	25 and 32 mm	Adjustable backpack straps	Same width as the D-ring
Swivel / lobster clasp	20 and 25 mm	Removable straps, wristlets	Choose a clasp rated metal, not alloy-coated plastic
Eyelet (grommet)	8 and 10 mm inner	Drawstring backpacks	Inner = cord thickness + 3–4 mm
Double-cap rivet	8 and 10 mm cap · post 6/8/10 mm	Leather tabs, strap ends	Post = total thickness + 1–2 mm
Cord stopper	Single or double hole	Drawstrings	Hole ≥ cord diameter

PRO RULE

Buy hardware in **one metal finish per bag** (all gold, all silver or all gunmetal). Mixed finishes are the fastest way to make a handmade bag look homemade.

SECTION 2

2. Lining without puckering

A lining stops stretching, hides the inside of the stitches and keeps pens from poking through.

Why linings pucker

TOO BIG

The fabric has nowhere to go and folds inside. You see ripples through the stitches.

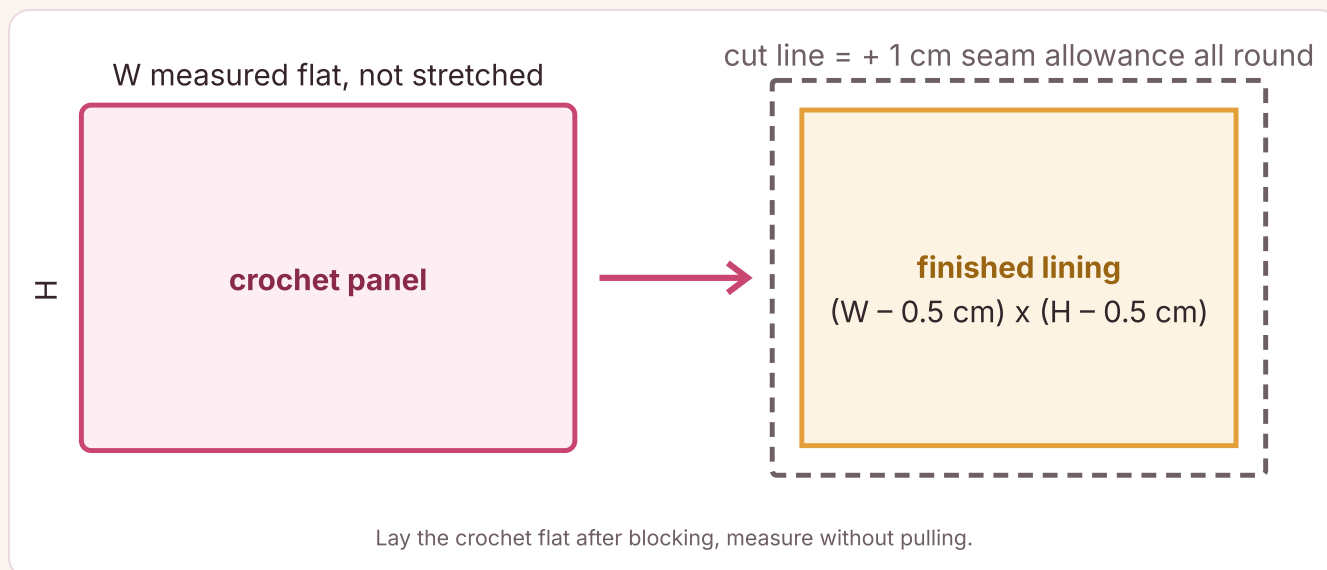
TOO SMALL

The lining pulls the crochet in: the top edge gathers and the bag looks "pinched".

PINNED STRETCHED

The crochet was pulled to fit while pinning and springs back later.

The measurement rule



FORMULA

Finished lining = crochet size – 0.5 cm (1/4 in) in width and height. **Cut size** = finished lining + 1 cm (3/8 in) seam allowance on every sewn edge, and + 2 cm (3/4 in) on the top edge, which is folded under instead of sewn.

Worked example — classic backpack 26 x 30 x 10 cm (10.25 x 11.75 x 4 in)

PIECE	FINISHED SIZE	CUT SIZE (WITH SEAM + FOLD)
Front / back (cut 2)	25.5 × 29.5 cm	27.5 × 32.5 cm / 10.75 × 12.75 in
Sides + bottom (cut 1 strip)	9.5 × 84.5 cm (29.5 + 25.5 + 29.5)	11.5 × 88.5 cm / 4.5 × 34.75 in
Inner slip pocket (cut 1, fold in half)	15 × 12 cm	17 × 26 cm / 6.75 × 10.25 in

Round-bottom backpack: cut a circle = bottom diameter – 0.5 cm + 2 cm, and a rectangle = (circumference – 1 cm + 2 cm) x (height + 3 cm). Clip the circle every 2 cm before sewing.

Step by step

- 1 Choose the fabric:** 100% quilting cotton or light canvas (110–200 g/m²). Prewash and iron it: cotton shrinks 3–5%.
- 2 Interface for structure (optional):** fuse a woven medium interfacing to the wrong side of the front/back panels.
- 3 Sew the lining** right sides together with 1 cm seams (by hand: backstitch, 3 mm stitches). Add the slip pocket first.
- 4 Do not turn it right side out.** The seams go against the crochet so they never rub on what's inside.
- 5 Fold the top edge** 2 cm to the wrong side and press.
- 6 Drop it inside** and match the side seams to the side folds of the bag. Clip at the 4 quarter points, then at the 8 eighths.

- 7 Ladder-stitch** the fold to the crochet one round below the top, catching one loop of each stitch. Never pull the crochet toward the fabric.

THE RULE THAT STOPS PUCKERS

Clip at quarter points before anything else. If the crochet has 64 stitches around, each quarter is 16 stitches: the fabric must land evenly in all four, not be "eased" into the last one.

SECTION 3

3. Zippers that don't wave

A zipper is a rigid line; crochet is stretchy. Waves happen when one of them is stretched to fit the other.

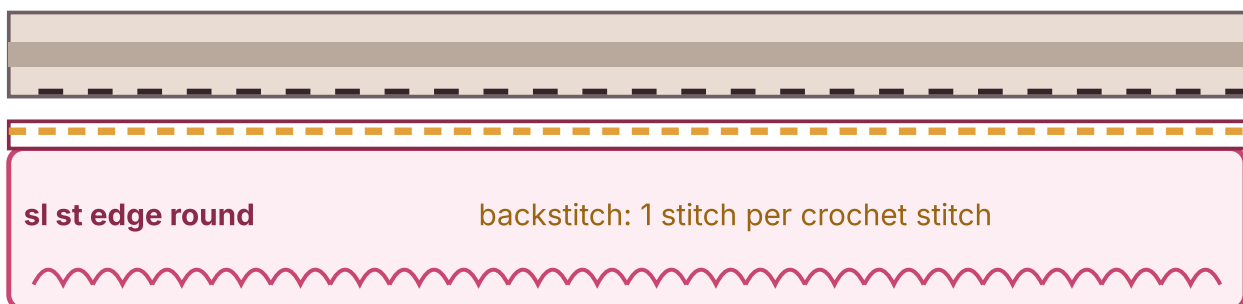
Choose the right length

OPENING (MEASURED FLAT)	ZIPPER TO BUY	COLLECTION PIECES
10–12 cm / 4–4.75 in	4 in / 10 cm	Coin purses 1, 2, 8
12–14 cm / 4.75–5.5 in	5 in / 12 cm	Pieces 7, 10
17–19 cm / 6.75–7.5 in	7 in / 18 cm	Pieces 4, 20
20–22 cm / 8–8.75 in	8 in / 20 cm	Pieces 13, 24
23–25 cm / 9–10 in	9 in / 23 cm	Pieces 28, 30
30 cm / 12 in	12 in / 30 cm	Piece 22
Backpack top 35–45 cm	14–18 in two-way	Zip-top backpacks

Rule: zipper length (stop to stop) = opening length, or up to 2 cm shorter. Never longer, or the crochet gets stretched along the tape. To shorten a coil zipper: whip-stitch 8 times over the coil at the new length (new stop), cut 1.5 cm below.

zipper tape (wrong side)

teeth: 3–5 mm above the crochet edge



Cross-section of a correctly placed zipper.

Method A — hand-sewn directly to the crochet (pouches, wallets)

- 1 Finish the opening with 1 round of sc + 1 round of loose sl st. This gives a firm, straight edge.
- 2 Close the zipper. Place it inside, teeth centered, 3–5 mm below the edge. Clip at both ends, the center and the quarters.
- 3 Baste with long running stitches in a contrasting thread. Open and close it: it must glide and lie flat.
- 4 Backstitch with doubled thread along the woven line of the tape, just under the sl st round: **one backstitch per crochet stitch**.
- 5 Whip-stitch the outer edge of the tape to the inside of the crochet so it doesn't flap. Remove the basting.
- 6 Fold tape ends down at 45° and tack them to the side fold.

Method B — zipper + lining as one unit (clutches, backpacks)

- 1 Sew the zipper to the top of the two lining panels first (right sides together, 5 mm seam, zipper foot or backstitch).
- 2 Sew the rest of the lining. You now have a lining pouch with the zipper at the top.
- 3 Drop it inside the crochet bag and clip at quarter points.
- 4 Hand-stitch the zipper tape to the crochet just under the edge round. The lining carries the stress; the crochet only holds position.

Method C — crochet straight into the tape

With an awl, make holes 5 mm apart along the tape, 4 mm from the teeth. Work 1 sc into each hole with a smaller hook (3 mm / C-2 or D-3). Count the sc: they must equal the stitches of the bag opening. Then join that sc row to the bag with sl st. Best for zipper pouches in cotton: 100% crochet finish.

WAVES IN ONE SENTENCE

Count first: if the opening has 38 stitches, the zipper side must also take exactly 38 stitches or holes. One extra stitch per 10 cm is what makes a wave.

SECTION 4

4. Straps that don't stretch

Cotton has no memory. A loaded backpack pulls 2–4 kg (4–9 lb) on two small points every day.

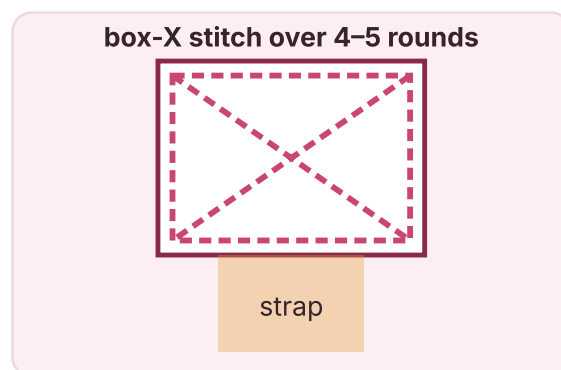
Four strap options, from most to least stretch-proof

OPTION	HOW	STRETCH	BEST FOR
1. Cotton or poly webbing	25–38 mm webbing, cut end sealed; crochet tabs cover the ends	None	School and daily backpacks

OPTION	HOW	STRETCH	BEST FOR
2. Crochet tube over webbing	Crochet a sc tube 2 sts wider than the webbing, slide it on, sew ends	None	When the strap must look fully crocheted
3. Dense crochet + core cord	Sc BLO with a hook 1 size smaller, working over a 3 mm cotton cord	Low	Light bags, crossbody
4. Leather / faux leather	Pre-made straps, riveted to crochet tabs	None	Premium pieces
Plain crochet	Sc or hdc rows only	High (+10–20% in a month)	Clutches, wristlets only

Anchor it like a pro

- **Never sew to the top round only.** Spread every anchor over 4–5 rounds or rows.
- **Backing patch:** put a 4 × 5 cm (1.5 × 2 in) felt or webbing patch inside; sew through crochet + patch.
- **Box-X stitch** with doubled upholstery thread: a rectangle and both diagonals.
- **Top anchor** of backpack straps: centered on the back, 3–4 cm (1.25–1.5 in) below the top edge, straps 2 cm apart.
- **Bottom anchors:** at the bottom corners, 2 rounds above the BLO base line, angled 30° outward.



Box-X through crochet + inner patch.

BACKPACK SIZE	STRAP LENGTH (EACH)	WIDTH	ADJUSTABLE RANGE
Mini / kids 3–6 y	50 cm / 20 in	20–25 mm	35–50 cm
Small / kids 7–12 y	60 cm / 24 in	25 mm	45–60 cm
Medium adult	75 cm / 30 in	25–32 mm	55–75 cm
Large adult	80 cm / 31.5 in	32–38 mm	60–80 cm

THE 24-HOUR WEIGHT TEST

Hang the finished bag with 2 kg / 4.4 lb inside (two 1-liter bottles) for 24 hours. Measure the straps before and after. More than 1 cm of growth = add a webbing core before you sell it.

SECTION 5

5. Magnetic snaps

The closure buyers try first when they pick up a bag at a fair.

Prong snaps (most common)

- 1 Mark the position with chalk: flap closed, press it and mark where the tip lands. Check again with the bag filled.
- 2 Cut a 3 × 3 cm (1.25 × 1.25 in) square of felt, plastic canvas or 2 layers of interfacing for each half.
- 3 Push the two prongs through the crochet **between stitches** — never cut the yarn.
- 4 Push them through the backing square too, then the metal washer.
- 5 Bend the prongs outward (flat against the washer) with a spoon handle or pliers.
- 6 Cover the back of each half with the lining, or a felt circle glued/sewn on.

Sew-in snaps

Covered in fabric with small holes on the edge. Sew them with doubled thread, 4 passes per hole, through crochet and a backing. Use them where prongs would show through open stitches (shell, V-stitch).

Size guide

YARN	SNAP
DK / worsted cotton	10–14 mm
3 mm cord	14 mm
5 mm cord, t-shirt yarn	18 mm

TIP

Install the snap **before** joining the panels whenever the pattern allows. It's 3 times easier on a flat piece.

SECTION 6

6. D-rings, slide adjusters & swivel clasps

The trio that makes a strap adjustable and removable.

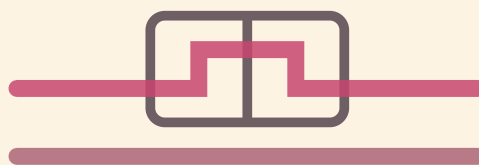
Strap tabs

Every D-ring hangs from a tab. Crochet tab for bags under 1 kg: ch 4, 3 sc x 6 rows (DK/worsted: ch 6, 5 sc x 10 rows). For backpacks: a 10 cm (4 in) piece of webbing, folded through the ring, sewn with box-X through the bag and a backing patch.

Adjustable backpack strap — assembly

- 1 Anchor the **top** end of the webbing (top anchor, box-X).
- 2 Thread the free end through the slide adjuster: up through slot 1, over the center bar, down slot 2.
- 3 Pass it through the D-ring on the bottom tab.
- 4 Bring it back up and thread it through the slide adjuster again, **under** the first layer.
- 5 Fold the end 2 cm twice and sew it (or seal it with a lighter if synthetic) so it can't slip out.

up slot 1 · over bar · down slot 2



2nd layer goes under: it locks

Threading a slide adjuster.

Swivel clasps

Use them for removable straps (wristlets, crossbody). Match the clasp opening to the D-ring thickness, and choose solid metal: coated zinc clasps open under 2–3 kg.

SIZE RULE

Sizes always go by **inner** width. A 25 mm (1 in) strap needs a 25 mm D-ring AND a 25 mm slide.

SECTION 7

7. Eyelets (grommets) & drawstrings

Metal eyelets give drawstring backpacks a clean, sporty finish — but crochet alone cannot hold them.

- 1 Choose the size: inner diameter = cord thickness + 3–4 mm. 5 mm cord → 8–10 mm eyelet.
- 2 Mark the positions on the eyelet round: an **even** number, 4–6 cm (1.5–2.5 in) apart, same stitch count between each.
- 3 Reinforce: sew a strip of felt or fusible interfacing (3 cm tall) inside, behind the eyelet round.
- 4 Open the hole with an awl between stitches (don't cut yarn). Enlarge until the eyelet post just fits.
- 5 Post from the outside, washer on the inside. Place on the anvil and hit the setter 2–3 times, firmly and straight.
- 6 Check: the washer must not turn by hand. If it does, one more hit.

No-metal option

Crochet eyelets instead: in the eyelet round, (sc 5, ch 2, sk 2) around; next round work 2 sc in each ch-2 space. Even number of eyelets, the cord enters and exits from the front.

Drawstring length

Circumference of the opening x 2 + 30 cm (12 in) for knots or stoppers. For a double drawstring (two cords, pulled from both sides) cut two cords of that length.

WARNING

Never place eyelets in the last round. Keep at least 2 rounds of crochet above them or the edge tears.

SECTION 8

8. Rivets

For leather tabs, strap ends and handles — the most durable joint in this guide.

- 1 Stack what you'll rivet: leather tab + crochet + a backing of leather, webbing or felt. **Never rivet through crochet alone** — the post pulls out.
- 2 Measure the total thickness. Post length = thickness + 1–2 mm (short 6 mm, medium 8 mm, long 10 mm).

WHERE	RIVETS	CAP
Leather flap tab	2	8 mm
Backpack strap end	2–4	10 mm
Handle (each end)	2	10 mm
Keyring tab	1	8 mm

- 3 Punch a 2.5–3 mm hole through the leather/backing; open the crochet between stitches with an awl.
- 4 Post from the back, cap from the front.
- 5 Cap on the concave anvil, setter on top, 2–3 firm hammer hits on a hard surface.

TIP

Buy 20% more rivets than you need: 1 in 5 goes crooked when you are learning. Practice on a scrap first.

SECTION 9

9. Troubleshooting & final quality check

PROBLEM	CAUSE	FIX
Zipper waves	More crochet stitches than zipper length, or tape sewn stretched	Unpick, re-clip at quarter points, 1 backstitch per stitch
Zipper edge gapes	Tape sewn too far from the teeth	Sew on the woven line, 3–5 mm from the teeth
Lining ripples	Lining too big	Take in the side seams 3–5 mm
Top edge gathered	Lining too small	Resew with the formula (crochet – 0.5 cm)
Strap tab pulls a hole	Sewn to 1 round only, no backing	Backing patch + box-X over 4–5 rounds
Straps grow	Plain crochet straps	Add webbing core or swap to webbing
Snap spins / pulls out	No backing square	Reinstall with felt or plastic canvas
Eyelet falls out	Crochet only, no reinforcement	Interfacing strip behind, correct post size
Rivet wobbles	Post too long	Shorter post, or add one more backing layer

Before you photograph or sell it

- ☐ Zipper glides end to end, one hand, with the bag full
- ☐ No lining visible from the outside at the top edge
- ☐ Straps passed the 24-hour 2 kg / 4.4 lb test
- ☐ All hardware in one metal finish
- ☐ Snaps and clasps opened and closed 20 times
- ☐ Every tail woven in 3 directions, no knots visible
- ☐ Care card inside (hand wash cold, dry flat, no iron on hardware)

The detail is the difference.

Crochet makes the bag. Lining, zipper and hardware make it look store-bought — and make it last long enough for the next order.

The Crochet Backpack Collection